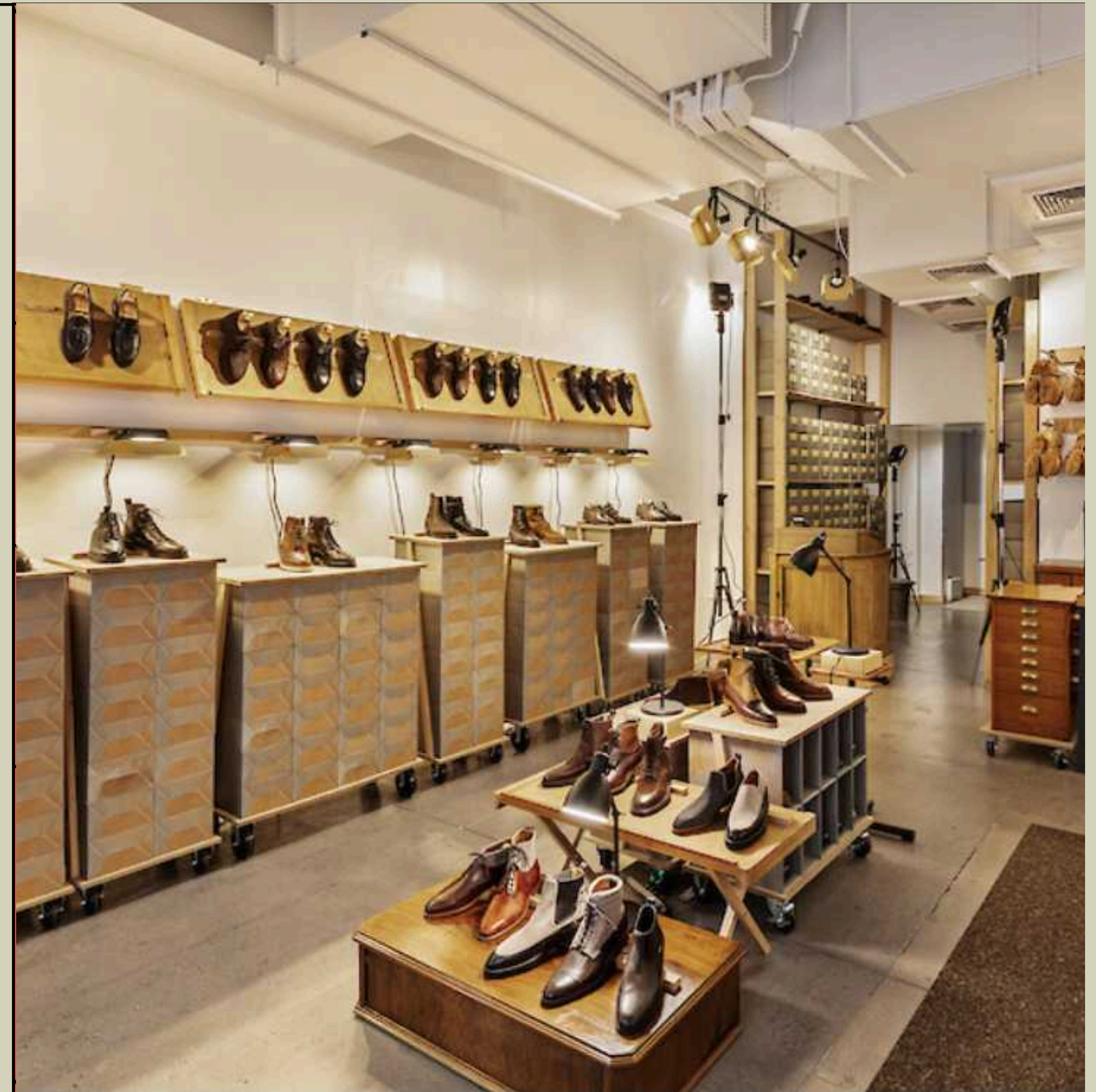
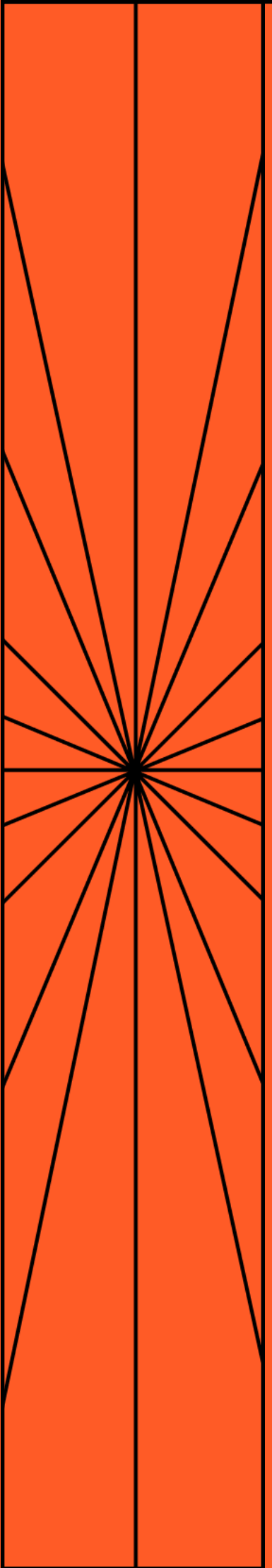


RESEARCH ASSIGNMENT: NYC ENTREPRENEURIAL MAKER

Lily Vosari | Entrepreneurial Making SP.26 |



Le Majordome NYC:
Daniel Bucheli



Meet the Company

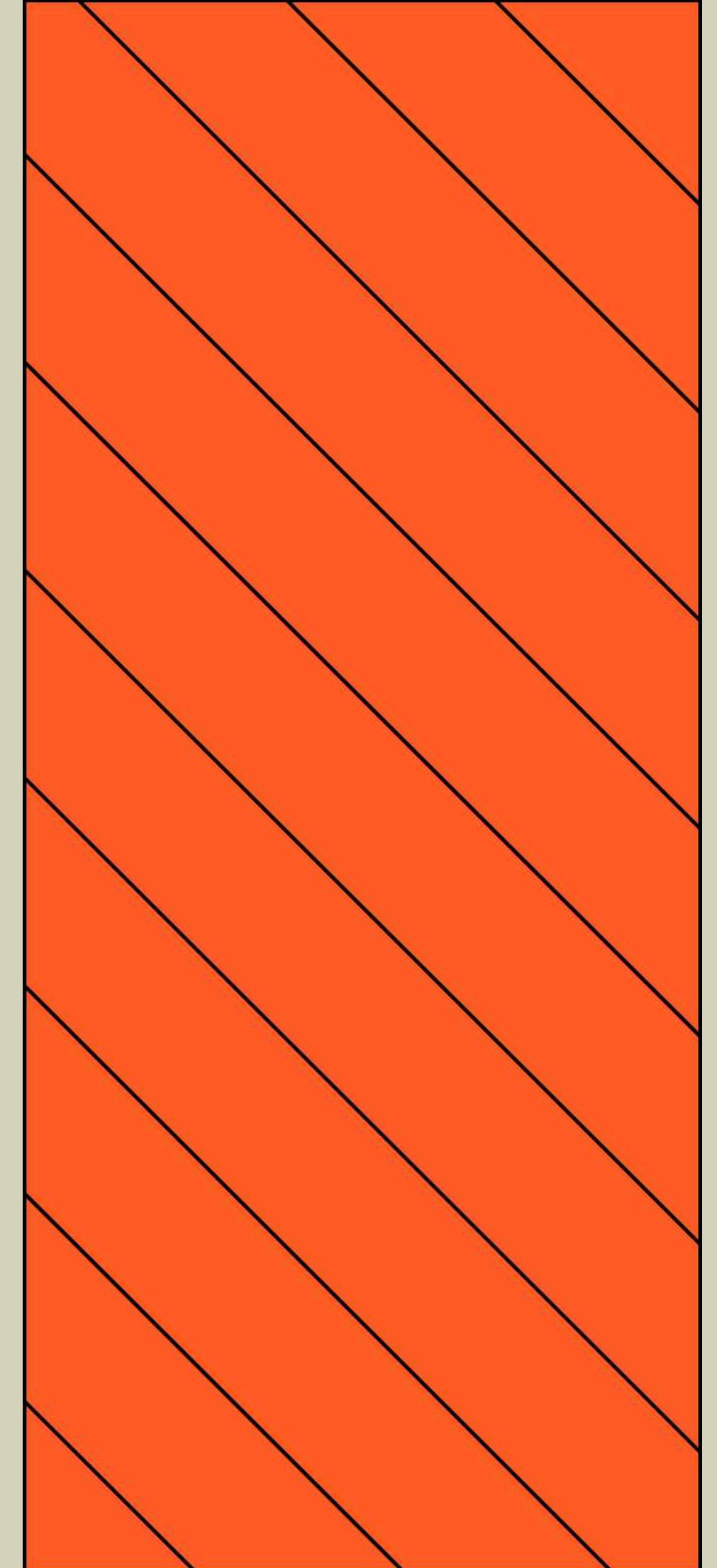
BUSINESS OVERVIEW

Le Majordome is a Swiss luxury shoemaker: the name of the company translates to “the butlers” in French. The company was founded in 2012, gaining its reputation in Switzerland before expanding internationally, with co-founders Cavigelli and Bucheli remaining the only two full-time office employee. This plays into the company’s design as it help form the theme of small company intentional design.

THE UNIQUE APPEAL

The unique appeal of the company is the company's promise to the customers.

- The core concept of the company is truly personalized, handcrafted shoes at a price point that doesn't require a small fortune.
- Appeal comes from the customization of the shoes; making the buyer feel as though they are not buying a shoe but they are designing one customized for themselves.
- There are no levels of approximation in which measurements and fit are not generalized for the public but are made to fit the buyer directly.
- The company has created an exclusive feel for the buyer without making it feel inaccessible to all: specifically creating a luxury experience that also makes the user feel as though the price markup is justified.
- The product is built to last and is able to be maintained. By focusing on made-to-order production, the brand cuts down on waste and aims to create shoes that last a lifetime. The NYC store also provides repair and maintenance services, further extending the life of each pair.
- Lastly, the brand ethos is able to match the modern luxury buyer's needs and wants: that differ from large fashion houses which have lost value in the user experience.



Business Operations: The Four Pillars of Entrepreneurial Making	
1. PRICING – VALUE-BASED, NOT DISCOUNT-DRIVEN	Le Majordome focus on precived values rather than competitive pricing with similar brands. Ready-to-wear models range between \$460 and \$750, with fully bespoke designs available for an additional fee. Le Majordome's pricing reflects both the genuine cost of premium Spanish craftsmanship and the brand's boutique overhead. The price point is a strategic tool high enough to signal quality and exclusivity, but controlled enough to reach a broader audience than traditional bespoke shoemakers.
2. MANUFACTURING – OUTSOURCED, BUT TIGHTLY CONTROLLED	Le Majordome production is not in-house but manufacturing is still a very hands on process. The brand partners exclusively works with a single, century-old shoe factory in Almansa, Spain. • Working solely with one factory keeps quality consistent and saves customers months in turnaround time compared to other made-to-measure shoemakers.
3. MARKETING – HYPERLOCAL AND AUDIENCE-SPECIFIC	Le Majordome's marketing approach is unconventional for a luxury brand. Rather than spending on social media ads, the brand took a guerrilla approach; which means they went to neighboring Madison Avenue retailers, encouraging them to refer customers, and hosting small happy hour events to build neighborhood awareness. In addition the brand receiving coverage in Highsnobiety and Bloomberg Businessweek. It was the Bloomberg feature that drove a spike in sales, revealing that their core customer was the Midtown office worker.
4. PROMOTIONS – WORD OF MOUTH AND EXCLUSIVE EVENTS	Le Majordome's promotional strategy leans on relationship building over advertising. This company focuses on housing exclusive corporate shopping events and specifically partnering with niche luxury communities . This creates a word of mouth and small independent brand identity, this intimate community vibe helps the brand prosper rather than just survive • One example of this is the brand ran a exclusive event which they made such as a limited run of 24 numbered loafers made in collaboration with a cigar brand, with each owner invited to a private event

INTERVIEW HIGHLIGHTS

"How do you define the value of your product beyond just the cost of materials?"

- The value is based on a fully personalized experience
 - custom fit
 - hand crafted construction
 - One on one expert guidance in shoe choices
 - No mass production alternatives

"How do your choices in materials impact your final retail price?"

- With the 94 material options that are provided ranging from calfskin to exotic leather, material directly impact the final price range by standard selections keep ready-to-wear between \$460–\$750. while rare or exotic materials push the cost into the fully bespoke tier above that.

"What is the biggest challenge in staying self-sufficient while trying to be efficient?"

- The brand intentionality stays small; with 2 full time staff members and a single trusted factory, it deliberately is capping growth to protect the brand indentily with the focus of quality, craftsmanship and the buyers experiance

PHOTOS FROM THE SHOP

